

FREEDOM FOR YOUR PROMISE

Text-Genesis 15:4-6/ 16:1-4

Genesis 15:4-6: Now the word of the Lord came to him: "This one will not be your heir; instead, one who comes from your own body will be your heir." He took him outside and said, "Look at the sky and count the stars, if you are able to count them." Then He said to him, "Your offspring will be that [numerous]." Abram believed the Lord, and He credited it to him as righteousness.

Genesis 16:1-4: Abram's wife Sara had not borne him children. She owned an Egyptian slave named Hagar. Sara said to Abram, "Since the Lord has prevented me from bearing children, go to my slave; perhaps I can have children by her." And Abram agreed to what Sara said. So Abram's wife Sara took Hagar, her Egyptian slave, and gave her to her husband Abram as a wife for him after Abram had lived in the land of Canaan 10 years. He slept with Hagar, and she became pregnant. When she realized that she was pregnant, she looked down on her mistress.

In chapter 16:2

And Sara said unto Abram, behold the Lord hath kept me from bearing: I pray thee go in unto my maid. It may be that I may obtain children by her, and Abram hearkened to the voice of Sara.

I want to speak to three different people groups tonight;

- Those who are not saved
- Those who want more of God
- Those who are waiting on a promise

God wants to bring freedom to your situation, but you must first learn to trust in him.

I. LET GO AND LET GOD...

Here we find Abram and Sara having a little trouble with God's promise. They are trying to figure out how to make it happen on their own.

This is where we get into trouble; we try to make something happen rather than waiting on God! If our desires are to be fulfilled by God, our pursuit of those desires must be kept in line with God's plan.

Like Sara, we begin to say, I know what God said, but maybe this is what he meant.

Sara believed God would fulfill His promise but she was not convinced He would do it

through her.

A lot of people believe God can heal. They are just not sure he will heal them. They believe He is able but they are not convinced He is willing. He is at least as willing as He is able to fulfill your promise!

A promise is a promise!

- If God gave you a promise, Satan is going to make sure that you are offered a substitute.
- Something almost like it, but not lasting, not fulfilling.
- If God gave you a promise then it will come to pass.

Don't trade an Isaac for an Ishmael...

Don't trade a promise for a substitute...

Abraham and Sara's plan brought forth Ishmael. God's plan brought forth Isaac! Remember, your plan will always be inferior to God's plan!

Their plan was so close to the promise that for 13 years Abram thought Ishmael was the promise.

Sometimes it's easier to keep the substitute!

The promise will not come easily!

Galatians 4:22-23 [Abraham had two sons, one from his slave-wife and one from his freeborn wife. The son of the slave-wife was born in a human attempt to bring about the fulfillment of God's promise. But the son of the freeborn wife was born as God's own fulfillment of his promise.](#)

God overrode the laws of nature to bring Abram's promise to life. God is no respecter of persons. He can override natural laws to bring your promise to pass! Don't be guilty of settling for an Ishmael; Ishmael is always a second rate substitute!

A lot of people in this day have settled for an Ishmael where salvation is concerned. They have settled for:

- Shaking the preacher's hand!
- Church membership!
- Religion!
- The live the way you want to path!
- The path of least resistance!

Nothing will take the place of repentance and forgiveness! Jesus told Nicodemus “[You MUST be BORN AGAIN!](#)”

Isaac was a type of Jesus. Jesus was the son of promise and only through Him is our covenant established.

Acts 2:38 tells us:

- There are no short cuts...
- There is no back door to God...
- There is no other way...

The only way to the promise is through the blood of Jesus!

Satan would like for you to give birth to an Ishmael where your salvation is concerned, to trust something besides the promise. God has given us a promise that creates new life in him!

John 3:16 tells us that God has done everything to forgive us, now it is up to us to receive our salvation and then walk in it!

God wants each of us to have freedom in every area of our life:

- In our praise...
- In our family...
- In our finances...
- In our mind...
- In our everyday walk with him...

If we can wait on him and not settle on a substitute, for the promise he has given us, then we can experience the freedom the Lord has for us. Hebrews 10 :36 [For we have need of patience, that, after we have done the will of God, we might receive the promise.](#)

I don't know what the promise is in your life; it may have to do with;

- your kids or spouse getting saved
- God bringing your family back together
- God setting you free from your past
- freedom from addiction
- generational curses being broken

- Whatever your situation may be, there is freedom here for you; it's up to you to wait on your promise and walk in that freedom. [Where the spirit of the lord is there is freedom.](#)

ALTAR CALL:

- Unsaved

- Needing something more from God
- Waiting on a promise